

PART TWO

Personal Finance

Personal finance is . . . well, personal. It's something that you probably don't discuss with your mailman or announce to family members in your annual holiday newsletter.

We're okay with that, and we'll never ask you to tell us a thing about where you keep your paychecks or who you owe money to. We will request that you listen to our stories, however. We've learned a whole lot about what works (and what doesn't). We also know that what doesn't kill us only makes us stronger if we're wise enough to remember the lessons we've learned and if we're willing to change our habits.

If you're uneasy about your financial situation and unsure

where to start, a budget may well be the very best thing you'll ever create. We will help you get on the right track, with tips for making it realistic, and encouraging goals that will tell you how you're doing.

When you're ready to move on to bigger, better topics, you'll find it here, too. Financial planning only *seems* intimidating until you start learning the basics. Once you get involved, you'll see a world filled with excitement and opportunities.